

Invisible data

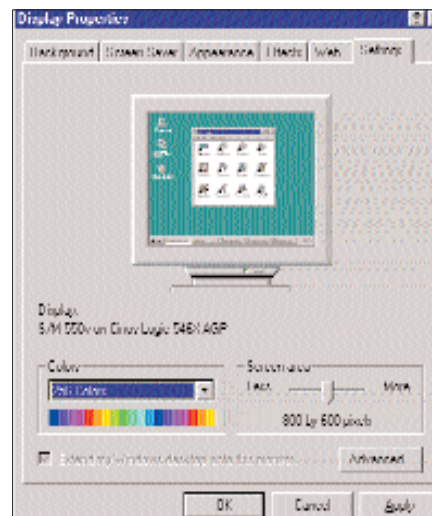
Q I have two hard drives, one is a 20 GB drive and the other is 40 GB. I had to transfer some of my files on to my friend's PC for which I detached my 40-GB drive and took it to his place. After transferring the files, I fixed it back on my machine. The problem is that now the drive fails to show any of my data in Windows environment but while booting, the boot-up screen shows that the hard drive is being detected. What could be the problem?

A It seems your FAT table has been corrupted. As a result, in spite of your hard disk being detected in the BIOS, it fails to show any data on the PC. You should try to recover the data by using reliable data recovery software. (Refer to the

drive and at the drive controller. Try re-attaching the signal cable if it is loose, or rather, try another signal cable to be sure that the cable is not the problem.

Finally, you could try replacing the floppy drive. If the problem persists, chances are that the floppy drive is defective. It could be that the head read/write system has failed. Try replacing the floppy drive with an optimal drive from another system to check if this is the problem.

If changing the floppy drive too does not resolve the problem, you may have a defective floppy drive controller circuit. If this is the case, you may also receive a floppy drive or controller error from the system BIOS while booting. Disabling the existing floppy controller and installing an expansion card controller can solve



Adjust your colour settings for proper display

Older graphics cards do not comply with the latest versions of the OpenGL and DirectX API

February issue of Digit for the story, Surviving a Hard Disk Crash)

FLOPPY DRIVE

No read-write floppy drive

Q I use Windows 98. My floppy drive does not read or write to floppy disks. What could be the reason and how do I solve this problem?

A This is a very common problem with floppy disks. The troubleshooting technique is as follows:

Start by checking the floppy, as this is the first point from where the problems begin. You could try changing diskettes a few times unless you are sure that the floppy disks are not faulty. Try a properly formatted diskette in your suspect drive. A faulty disk can generate some very inconsistent read and write problems.

Try cleaning the floppy drive next. Clean the read/write heads thoroughly. There are head cleaning disks available in the market that do a decent job of cleaning the drive. However, make sure that you do not run the drive with a head-cleaning disk inserted for more than 30 seconds at a time, or you could damage the heads with excessive friction.

Your next suspect should be the signal cable. Make sure that the drive's 34-pin ribbon cable is attached securely at the

this; the floppy controller portion is left enabled.

Floppy drive LED stays on

Q I recently upgraded my system. Ever since, as soon as I boot my PC, the floppy drive LED stays on. Is this some kind of a virus?

A No, this is not a virus. The problem here is that one end of the drive cable has been inserted backwards. Open the CPU case and make sure that pin 1 on the 34-pin cable is aligned properly with the connector on both the drive and controller. This usually solves the problem in most of the cases. The failure of the drive controller can also cause this problem, although this is somewhat rare.

GRAPHICS CARD

Only 256 colours displayed by systems

Q My system is unable to display more than 256 colours. How do I get it to display more colours?

A First, for your system to display more than 256 colours, you should have at least a 1 MB graphics card. In today's time, a 4 MB graphics card is the lowest configuration card available in the mar-

ket. Hence, we suspect you are facing a driver problem. Either you've removed or installed incorrect drivers. In case you have upgraded your operating system from Windows 98 to Windows 2000, you will need to load the set of drivers specially developed for this OS. You can install the drivers from the diskette that came with the graphics card or download these drivers straight from the developer's Web site. Once you have installed the appropriate drivers, you will automatically get an option of 16, 24 or 32-bit, depending upon the type of graphics card you use. Now your graphics card will be able to display more colours.

16 MB card shows as 8 MB

Q I have a 16 MB TNT2 graphics card but my system shows it as an 8-MB card. Why?

A The RAM on your card may not be functioning properly, hence it would be better if you sent it back to the dealer for testing. However, before you send it, open the PC and remove the graphics card and check if rust or dust has affected the chips. Clean the chips gently and then reinsert the card. Now start your machine and if it still shows as 8 MB on boot up, then you will have to replace your card.

Monitor goes on the blink when playing games

Q I have a Trident 9750 3D accelerator graphics card. However, whenever I try to play games such as *Quake III* or *Need for Speed*, my monitor automatically goes in